Exactly two days later Suchcha contacted Sartaj for another meeting. They met at the same restaurant and Suchcha handed him a brown envelope.

'These are the names and photos of people travelling to India this month. They are our guys,' he said calmly.

Mathur couldn't believe his luck. Suchcha had passed the loyalty test. He told Suchcha that Sartaj would be in touch with him soon and they would never again meet at this restaurant. The next day Mathur dispatched the envelope through a diplomatic pouch and waited for good news from Delhi. The security agencies had no records of the suspects provided by Suchcha. Several copies were made and various airports were put on high alert. The intelligence helped arrest at least six militants. They were whisked away from the media glare to an interrogation centre in South Delhi. Mathur was informed that his asset was gold. Suchcha was given a source number in the spy files. He was codenamed Blue Sky.

In the next few months, Suchcha provided not only the names of militants travelling to India but also of financiers of the Khalistan movement in the US and Canada. He had also revealed the name of a leader who was coordinating with Pakistan's Inter Service Intelligence (ISI) and was said to have a hotline with its chief, Lt. General Hamid Gul. Mathur and Sartaj had pulled off a brilliant coup, which inflicted serious damage to Chohan's network in US.

The Khalistan movement has a long and complex history. In 1966, after the formation of Punjab as a state meant for Punjabi speaking people, political and religious leaders sought more autonomy for the state. The agitation and propaganda remained local till 1970. It became global in 1971 when the